Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

"Why did plots and foreign threats push Elizabeth towards war?"

MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569-88

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 118 Crucial Questions

Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app/units/eee/mastery_pack_KT2.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- 🟩 **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- 🟨 **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- 🟥 **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

- ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
- ⭐ ⭐ **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
- ⭐ **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	Which Protestant Bishop of Durham did the Northern Earls strongly resent?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which two Catholic nobles led the Revolt of the Northern Earls in 1569?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What major religious building did the Northern Earls capture to celebrate a Catholic Mass?	☐	☐	☐	
4	Roughly how many rebels did Elizabeth execute after the Northern Earls' revolt?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What was the theological meaning of the 1570 Papal excommunication?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What strict law was passed in 1581 regarding Catholic conversions?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Who was the Italian banker that orchestrated a plot in 1571?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Which foreign commander was supposed to lead 10,000 Spanish troops during the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
9	Which high-ranking English nobleman was executed in 1572 for his involvement in the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which plot in 1583 involved the French Duke of Guise invading England with Spanish money?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What document was created after the Throckmorton Plot stating Mary would be killed if Elizabeth was assassinated?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Who was Elizabeth's Secretary of State and Spymaster?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What term is used for spies, like Gilbert Gifford, who secretly encourage others to commit treason?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Who was the expert cryptographer that deciphered Mary's letters for	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	Walsingham?				
15	Which 1586 plot provided the final, irrefutable written proof of Mary's guilt?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What specific Act of Parliament was used to try and convict Mary, Queen of Scots?	☐	☐	☐	
17	In what year was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?	☐	☐	☐	
18	Name two "new men" at court whose rise to power angered the old northern nobility.	☐	☐	☐	
19	What did Walsingham find in Francis Throckmorton's house that caused immense panic?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Which Spanish Ambassador was expelled following the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Which two northern Catholic earls led the 1569 rebellion?	☐	☐	☐	
22	Which Catholic cathedral did the Northern Earls seize to celebrate the Latin Mass?	☐	☐	☐	
23	What papal bull excommunicated Elizabeth I in 1570?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Which English duke was executed in 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
25	Who was Queen Elizabeth's Spymaster General from 1573?	☐	☐	☐	
26	How did plotters smuggle coded messages to Mary Stuart during the Babington Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
27	What skilled cryptographer decoded Mary Stuart's letters for Walsingham?	☐	☐	☐	
28	What 1584 document pledged to execute anyone who attempted to assassinate Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
29	In which castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587?	☐	☐	☐	
30	Approximately how many northern rebels did Elizabeth execute after the 1569 revolt?	☐	☐	☐	
31	Who was the devout Catholic King of Spain during Elizabeth's reign?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What term describes sailors officially licensed by the government to rob enemy ships?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Which famous English privateer stole roughly £400,000 of Spanish treasure during his circumnavigation?	☐	☐	☐	
34	What region did Spain control that Elizabeth sent troops to support in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
35	What was the name of the 1585 treaty where Elizabeth officially supported the Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Which English commander was sent to the Netherlands with 7,400 troops?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What 1587 event removed the Catholic alternative to the English throne, prompting Philip to invade?	☐	☐	☐	
38	In what year did Francis Drake raid Cadiz to delay the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
39	What famous phrase was used to describe Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
40	In what year did the Spanish Armada set sail?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT2.2: Relations with Spain

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Who was the inexperienced Spanish commander of the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
42	Whose army was the Armada supposed to pick up from the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What defensive shape did the Spanish fleet sail in as they travelled up the English Channel?	☐	☐	☐	
44	What type of new, fast, and highly manoeuvrable warships did the English use?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Where did the Spanish mistakenly drop their anchors, making them vulnerable?	☐	☐	☐	
46	What devastating tactic did the English use at midnight to break the Spanish formation at Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What major naval battle took place immediately after the fireships scattered the Spanish fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
48	Why couldn't the Armada pick up the Spanish army in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
49	Which way was the Armada forced to sail to get home?	☐	☐	☐	
50	What destroyed the majority of the Spanish ships as they tried to return home?	☐	☐	☐	
51	Which Spanish king had previously been married to Elizabeth’s sister Mary I?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What religion was Philip II, positioning himself as champion of the Counter-Reformation?	☐	☐	☐	
53	What Spanish monopoly prohibited English merchants from trading in the Americas?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What term describes state-licensed sea captains who raided	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	enemy merchant ships?				
55	Which English privateer became the first to circumnavigate the globe (1577–80)?	☐	☐	☐	
56	What famous Spanish treasure ship was captured by Drake off Ecuador in 1579?	☐	☐	☐	
57	How much silver and treasure did Drake capture from the *Cacafuego*?	☐	☐	☐	
58	Where did Elizabeth publicly knight Francis Drake in 1581?	☐	☐	☐	
59	Why was Philip II enraged by Elizabeth knighting Francis Drake?	☐	☐	☐	
60	What Dutch territory revolted against Philip II's rule in 1566?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	Under which previous monarch were England and Spain actually allies?	☐	☐	☐	
62	What did Elizabeth seize from Italian ships sheltering in English ports in 1568?	☐	☐	☐	
63	How much Spanish gold and silver did Francis Drake capture between 1577 and 1580?	☐	☐	☐	
64	Which Dutch Protestant rebel leader was assassinated in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	
65	Which 1584 treaty allied Catholic France and Spain together?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What 1585 agreement saw Elizabeth officially pledge military support to the Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	
67	How many soldiers did Elizabeth agree to send to the Netherlands in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	
68	Which English commander was sent to lead the troops in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
69	What title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands that infuriated Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
70	Name one of the English officers who defected to the Spanish side, damaging Dutch trust.	☐	☐	☐	
71	What deep-water port did Dudley successfully prevent the Spanish from capturing?	☐	☐	☐	
72	Why was the defense of Ostend so important for England's future?	☐	☐	☐	
73	In what month and year did Francis Drake launch his preemptive raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What famous phrase was used to describe Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
75	Roughly how many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour?	☐	☐	☐	
76	What crucial supply item did Drake destroy at Cadiz that later caused Spanish food to rot?	☐	☐	☐	
77	How long did Drake's raid on Cadiz delay the launch of the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Why was this delay so significant for Elizabeth's government?	☐	☐	☐	
79	Which Dutch Protestant leader was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What treaty between Philip II and the French Catholic League was signed in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	What 1585 treaty committed English troops to fight alongside Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	
82	Who was appointed commander of the 7,400 English soldiers sent to the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
83	What controversial political title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands, outraging Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
84	Which brilliant Spanish general commanded the Army of Flanders in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
85	In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch a daring surprise raid in April 1587?	☐	☐	☐	
86	How many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour in 36 hours?	☐	☐	☐	
87	What famous phrase described Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
88	What vital naval supplies did Drake destroy at Cadiz that crippled the Armada's food storage?	☐	☐	☐	
89	Who had Elizabeth rejected a marriage proposal from in 1559?	☐	☐	☐	
90	Which Pope gave his blessing to the Armada, turning it into a Catholic crusade?	☐	☐	☐	
91	How much money did the Pope promise Philip if the Armada was successful?	☐	☐	☐	
92	What 1584 treaty between France and Spain isolated England and pushed Philip closer to war?	☐	☐	☐	
93	The execution of which monarch in 1587 gave Philip II his final political motivation to invade?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
94	What was the name of the inexperienced commander chosen by Philip to lead the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
95	How many ships made up the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
96	What highly effective, defensive shape did the Spanish fleet sail in?	☐	☐	☐	
97	Who commanded the Spanish land army waiting in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
98	What type of small rebel ships blockaded the Spanish army in the shallow coastal waters?	☐	☐	☐	
99	At which port did the Armada mistakenly drop anchor to wait for the land army?	☐	☐	☐	
100	What devastating tactic did the English use at midnight to break the Spanish formation?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20
Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____
Date: _____

KT2.4: The Armada

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	How many fireships did the English send into the Spanish fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
102	What was the name of the major naval battle that took place the day after the fireships were used?	☐	☐	☐	
103	Why were English cannons able to fire more quickly than the Spanish during this battle?	☐	☐	☐	
104	Which way was the Armada forced to sail to escape the English fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
105	What nickname did the English give to the storms that destroyed the fleeing Spanish ships?	☐	☐	☐	
106	Where did Elizabeth deliver her famous speech to her troops ("I have the heart and stomach of a king")?	☐	☐	☐	
107	What famous piece of propaganda was painted to celebrate the victory?	☐	☐	☐	
108	Did the defeat of the Armada in 1588 mean the end of the war with Spain?	☐	☐	☐	
109	How many ships sailed in the Spanish Armada in May 1588?	☐	☐	☐	
110	Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada by Philip II?	☐	☐	☐	
111	What veteran Spanish army in the Netherlands was the Armada supposed to collect?	☐	☐	☐	
112	Who served as Lord High Admiral commanding the English fleet in 1588?	☐	☐	☐	
113	What naval treasurer revolutionized English galleon design with lower forecastles?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
114	What long-range naval cannon allowed English ships to bombard Spanish galleons from safety?	☐	☐	☐	
115	What defensive formation did the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel?	☐	☐	☐	
116	What terrifying tactic did the English use at midnight on 7 August off Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
117	What decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 off the Flemish coast?	☐	☐	☐	
118	What route were the surviving Spanish ships forced to take back to Spain?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

1. James Pilkington
2. The Earl of Northumberland and the Earl of Westmorland
3. Durham Cathedral
4. 450
5. Being formally excluded from the Catholic Church and unable to receive sacraments
6. It became high treason to convert anyone to Catholicism
7. Roberto Ridolfi
8. The Duke of Alba
9. The Duke of Norfolk
10. The Throckmorton Plot
11. The Bond of Association
12. Sir Francis Walsingham
13. Agents provocateurs
14. Thomas Phelippes
15. The Babington Plot
16. The Act for the Preservation of the Queen's Safety
17. 1587
18. William Cecil, Robert Dudley, or John Forster
19. A list of Catholic sympathisers / proof of the "enemy within"
20. Mendoza
21. The Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland
22. Durham Cathedral
23. Regnans in Excelsis
24. The Duke of Norfolk (Thomas Howard)
25. Sir Francis Walsingham
26. Inside the bungs of beer barrels
27. Thomas Phelippes
28. The Bond of Association
29. Fotheringhay Castle
30. Approximately 450 rebels



KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

31. King Philip II
32. Privateers
33. Sir Francis Drake
34. The Netherlands
35. The Treaty of Nonsuch
36. The Earl of Leicester / Robert Dudley
37. The execution of Mary, Queen of Scots
38. 1587
39. "Singeing the King of Spain's beard"
40. 1588

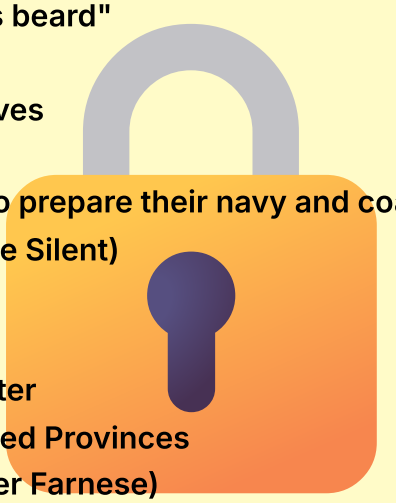


KT2.2: Relations with Spain

41. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
42. The Duke of Parma's army
43. A crescent formation
44. Galleons
45. Calais
46. Fireships
47. The Battle of Gravelines
48. Poor communication / Parma's army was not ready in time
49. North, around the coasts of Scotland and Ireland
50. Fierce storms / The weather / The "Protestant Wind"
51. King Philip II of Spain
52. Roman Catholic
53. The trade monopoly on Spanish New World colonies
54. Privateers
55. Sir Francis Drake
56. The *Nuestra Señora de la Concepción* (nicknamed the *Cacafuego*)
57. Over £140,000 (worth tens of millions today)
58. On board the *Golden Hind* at Deptford
59. He viewed Drake as a common pirate and thief of Spanish property
60. The Netherlands (Spanish Netherlands)

KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

61. Mary Tudor
62. The Genoese Loan
63. £400,000
64. William of Orange
65. The Treaty of Joinville
66. The Treaty of Nonsuch
67. 7,400 troops
68. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester
69. Governor General
70. William Stanley or Rowland York
71. Ostend
72. It meant the Spanish Armada wouldn't have a deep-water port to pick up troops from a year later
73. April 1587
74. "Singeing the King of Spain's beard"
75. 30 ships
76. Seasoned wooden barrel staves
77. By roughly one year
78. It bought England vital time to prepare their navy and coastal defences
79. William of Orange (William the Silent)
80. The Treaty of Joinville
81. The Treaty of Nonsuch
82. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester
83. Governor-General of the United Provinces
84. The Duke of Parma (Alexander Farnese)
85. Cadiz Harbour
86. Approximately 30 ships
87. "Singeing the King of Spain’s Beard"
88. Seasoned oak barrel staves (ruining water and provisions)
89. King Philip II of Spain
90. Pope Sixtus V



KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

91. One million gold ducats
92. The Treaty of Joinville
93. Mary, Queen of Scots
94. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
95. 130
96. A crescent formation
97. The Duke of Parma
98. Dutch flyboats
99. Calais
100. Fireships



KT2.4: The Armada

101. Eight
102. The Battle of Gravelines
103. They were mounted on smaller gun carriages, allowing them space to recoil and reload
104. Northwards, around Scotland and Ireland
105. The "Protestant Wind"
106. Tilbury
107. The Armada Portrait
108. No, the war continued for another 15 years and Philip built more armadas
109. 130 ships
110. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
111. The Duke of Parma's Army of Flanders (27,000 troops)
112. Lord Howard of Effingham
113. Sir John Hawkins
114. Culverins
115. The tight Crescent Formation
116. Eight Hellburners / Fireships
117. The Battle of Gravelines
118. North around Scotland and the west coast of Ireland

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 118 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/118)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

1. My ultimate strength in this unit is...

2. The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...

3. Key targets and action steps for the next retrieval attempt: